

Nokia 5210



Radical in design and construction, this is one of the few phones that is resilient to dust and moisture. With a robust two-part shell, the rubberised body increases the phone's resistance to physical shock and looks very unconventional. The entire shell of the phone can be changed according to your preference and its construction is such that changing it is especially simple. There are loads of features besides the Reminder, To-do lists and calendar—for instance, an integrated thermometer which could be used for whatever you see fit! The key layout of the phone is very intuitive and like all other

Nokia 5210		B+
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Warranty	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

Nokia phones, so is the menu navigation. At 1.29 inches, the LCD screen is noticeably smaller than most other phones but the screen has a higher resolution than the Nokia 3310, for example, and therefore readability is not compromised. The phone also features WAP and there are five games included. Another impressive feature is the 250-entry phonebook memory. One shortcoming is the phone's on/off switch—you have to press down with all your might. The 5210 exhibited excellent audio quality. The phone uses a Li-Ion battery pack and the talk time for the phone was logged at a commendable 115 minutes. This phone is a good choice for people who need a rugged phone.

Price: Rs 11,500

- + Robust construction, WAP, large phonebook memory
- The on/off switch is difficult to operate

its sensitivity to the network at various locations. The best of class here was once again the Sony Ericsson T68i. With an enormous storage capacity (it allows you to store up to 510 contacts in the phone book) and separate areas for storing SMS and MMS messages, you will find it very difficult to run out of memory on this phone. With a powerful Li-Ion battery pack, this phone boasts a rated standby time of up to 16 days and a talk time of about 6 hours! This is amongst the highest talk times offered in the industry.

A number of phones came in a close second, such as the Nokia 5510 with its exceptional voice loudness—one of the loudest in this roundup. This phone also boasts of good storage capabilities with a 100-entry address book on the phone along with the capability to store up to 100 SMS messages. The standby time is rated at a very commendable 10 days. Another impressive factor in this phone is its ability to pick up a reliable network signal across the various zones that were used to test for network sensitivity. It registered full network signal strength in

the stairwell zone, a place where most phones registered considerably lower signal strengths.

Then there is the Panasonic EB-GD75 with its 200-entry phonebook memory and a very good talk time logged at 3 hours with a six-day standby time. An outstanding feature of this phone is that when we charged the completely drained battery, it was able to recharge to maximum capacity in just one hour! This phone also registered very good network sensitivity and logged a good signal even in areas where other phones

Choose the Right Talk Plan

Understand your talk patterns
Do you plan to use your cell phone as an extension of your landline or do you plan to use it infrequently or in case of emergencies? In the former case, it would make more sense to go in for a billing talk plan that offers free phone calls with extras like night time reduced rates and free calls to numbers of your choice. Most billing plans available today include just the bare minimum services and features and everything else that you would want (caller ID, ISD/STD facility, etc) comes at an extra price. Be careful how you choose these features as they could add up to a significant amount on your monthly bill. Prepaid cards are suitable for users who do not use their phone very often and who want to keep a close check on their usage without the risk of being over-billed.

Keep an eye on the clock
Speak only as much as you have to. Long-winded conversations are expensive. Most phones have a feature that causes it to beep at the end of every minute of talk time. Use this feature to keep a check on how long your calls are. Most plans have a pulse time of 1 minute and therefore you should keep your calls such that conversations do not (as far as possible) overflow into the next minute.

Talk only when you have to
Use your cellular phone only when you do not have access to a landline. If you need to get a small amount of information to people, opt for sending an SMS message—this works out much cheaper than making a call.

Beware of SMS overload
This is the most elusive of them all. Since it is very simple and convenient to hit the 'forward' button and send that SMS joke to a friend, most people don't even give it a second thought. The cumulative costs of sending SMS messages can comprise of a sizeable chunk of your phone bills every month. As far as possible, use SMS only to send useful information and only the very good jokes!

Sharing your phone
Beware of friends and strangers who need to use your phone for making calls. Get into the habit of politely telling them that your phone bill is especially high this month and tell them to keep it short.